

Sidewalk Stories LA

One Page Funder Prospectus

Trevor Damyan, Founder | Los Angeles, CA | sidewalkstoriesla.org (coming soon)

The Problem

Cracked, lifted, and root damaged sidewalks are one of the most common safety hazards in Los Angeles neighborhoods. Responsibility for repair is often unclear between property owners and the city. Damaged sidewalks go unaddressed for years, creating real fall risk for pedestrians, seniors, and people with mobility challenges.

The City of Los Angeles estimates there are thousands of miles of damaged sidewalks across the city. The repair backlog is measured in years, not months. For property owners, the cost of a single panel repair can be \$1,500 or more, which means many homeowners simply wait. For pedestrians, especially older adults and people using wheelchairs or walkers, a single lifted panel is a daily obstacle.

The Solution

Sidewalk Stories LA repairs broken and hazardous sidewalk panels and transforms each one into a small public mosaic, designed and built by local kids working alongside a professional teaching artist and a licensed concrete crew.

Residents submit photos of damaged sections through a mobile app. The community votes. The top voted panel gets selected. A licensed crew completes the structural fix, then a teaching artist leads neighborhood kids in designing and building a mosaic on that panel, creating a lasting piece of public art in a place that used to be a hazard.

What makes this different: We do not just fix sidewalks. We turn the repair process into a public art and youth education moment. Every panel becomes a story the neighborhood tells together.

Who Benefits

Pedestrians and neighborhood residents: Safer sidewalks, especially seniors and people with limited mobility. A single repaired panel removes a tripping hazard that may have existed for years.

Youth participants: Hands on public art experience, civic pride, and a visible contribution to their neighborhood. Kids who participate in the mosaic design and installation gain skills in design, teamwork, and public collaboration. They also build a direct connection to civic life at an early age.

Local businesses and sponsors: Sponsored panels carry their logo and social visibility at a modest investment. A business that sponsors a panel gets permanent public recognition on the mosaic, professional before and after photography, and social media content that tags the business and the young artists.

The broader community: Each completed panel creates a visible marker of neighborhood investment. It shows that residents can identify a problem, vote on a solution, and see real results.

The Pilot (Year 1)

We are launching with a 10 panel pilot in one Los Angeles neighborhood.

Program Metrics

- Panels completed: 10
- Youth participants: 60 to 100
- Community submissions via app: 200+
- Votes cast: 1,000+
- Total program budget: \$38,700
- Revenue from grants, sponsors, and donations: \$25,250
- Founder bridge (to be closed): \$13,450

Cost Breakdown Per Panel

- Concrete prep and structural repair (licensed crew): \$900
- Mosaic materials (tile, grout, sealant, safety gear for kids): \$1,000
- Teaching artist / program lead stipend: \$400
- City right of way permit: \$400
- Total variable cost per panel: \$2,700

Fixed Operating Costs (Year 1)

- Bookkeeping and nonprofit administration: \$300 per month
- General liability and program insurance: \$250 per month
- App hosting and maintenance: \$200 per month
- Marketing and social content: \$100 per month
- Total fixed cost per month: \$850
- Total fixed cost for Year 1: \$10,200

One Time Startup Costs

- 501(c)(3) formation, legal, and filing fees: \$1,000
- Branding and basic website: \$500
- Total startup cost: \$1,500

Revenue Sources (Year 1)

- Individual donations (monthly ramp from \$250 to \$750): \$6,000
- Corporate sponsorships (5 panels at \$750 each): \$3,750
- Small community arts grant (Quarter 2): \$5,000

- Medium youth development grant (Quarter 4): \$10,000
- Events and merchandise: \$500
- Total Year 1 revenue: \$25,250

Scaling Path

Year 2: Scale to 30 panels across three neighborhoods. Revenue grows to approximately \$95,000 through larger grants and expanded sponsorships. Total costs reach approximately \$91,000, making the program break even or slightly positive.

Year 3: Expand to 60 or more panels annually. By this point, the program has a track record, a portfolio of completed mosaics, and a diversified funding base of grants, sponsors, and recurring donations. The program becomes self sustaining.

Why This Approach Works

This program pairs a tangible civic need (sidewalk safety) with an engaging community process and a youth arts program. Funders get measurable public safety impact, a strong visual story, and community driven outcomes they can see and share.

Unlike traditional public art grants that fund a single installation, Sidewalk Stories LA creates a repeatable, neighborhood based model. Each panel is a small project with a visible outcome, which means funders see results quickly. The app based voting and documentation create transparency and community engagement metrics that grant officers value.

Funding Opportunity

We are seeking grant and sponsorship partners for our pilot year. Partners receive:

- Public recognition on the mosaic panel and all digital content
- Before and after documentation with professional photography
- Social media campaign tagging the sponsor and young artists
- An annual impact report showing outcomes
- A direct, visible improvement in the neighborhood they support

Grant partner levels:

- Panel Sponsor: \$750 funds one complete panel
- Neighborhood Sponsor: \$5,000 funds two panels plus program support
- Founding Partner: \$10,000 or more, named in all Year 1 materials

Next Step

We would welcome a conversation about how a funding partnership could be structured for our pilot year. Our full budget, board bios, and program timeline are available on request.

Trevor Damyan, Founder Sidewalk Stories LA Los Angeles, CA

This document is for prospective funding partners. Financial model and supporting materials available upon request.